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IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF MEASURE PFD BY THE CITY ATTORNEY

The "City of Pasadena 911 Firefighter/Paramedic Emergency Medical/Wildfire Preparedness/Response Measure" was placed on the ballot by the Pasadena City Council. If approved by two-thirds of Pasadena voters, the Measure would establish a dedicated and restricted special parcel tax to fund both the operational and capital needs of the Pasadena Fire Department. Revenues from the Measure would be deposited into a special fund and used exclusively to support critical emergency response services, including firefighter and paramedic staffing, wildfire readiness, and brush and debris removal, as well as essential capital improvements such as the construction, repair, replacement, and modernization of fire stations and fire facilities, emergency alerting communications systems, ambulances, apparatus, and other public safety infrastructure and equipment.

The Measure is a special tax. The Measure establishes a fixed parcel tax rate of 19 cents per square foot of improved property. Low-income exemptions, including low-income seniors, are available for qualified property owners. The Measure is estimated to generate approximately $22.1 million annually and will automatically expire after 14 years.

The Measure would provide additional funding above the current baseline to expand wildfire-mitigation efforts, enhance paramedic and 911 response capability, support maintenance and modernization of lifesaving equipment, and enable the Fire Department to carry out capital improvements necessary to maintain reliable emergency response operations. This additional revenue is intended to enhance, supplement, or expand services and infrastructure beyond existing levels.

If approved, the Measure requires annual independent financial audits, public spending disclosure, and City Council oversight to ensure transparency and compliance. All funds must be used exclusively for local fire protection, emergency medical response, wildfire preparedness, brush clearance programs, emergency alert communications systems, and related operational and capital needs.

If the Measure is not approved, the City will not have access to this dedicated funding source. Without additional funding, the City may face limitations in sustaining or expanding wildfire mitigation programs, brush clearance work, or needed capital improvements. The City would continue relying on available resources to meet increasing public safety demands.

A "yes" vote approves the special parcel tax at a fixed rate of 19 cents per square foot of improved property, dedicated exclusively to local fire protection, emergency medical response, wildfire preparedness, and related public safety purposes, with accountability requirements and a 14 year sunset.

A "no" vote rejects the special parcel tax, leaving the City to fund fire and emergency services with available resources only.

Michele Beal Bagneris
City Attorney/City Prosecutor

THE ABOVE STATEMENT IS AN IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF MEASURE PFD. YOU MAY FIND THE MEASURE AND INFORMATION RELATED TO THE MEASURE ON THE CITY OF PASADENA WEBSITE AT www.CityofPasadena.net/elections AND THE CITY OF PASADENA'S MEASURE INFORMATION WEBSITE AT https://www.cityofpasadena.net/MeasurePFD